



Senate

General Assembly

File No. 154

February Session, 2026

Senate Bill No. 275

Senate, March 24, 2026

The Committee on Planning and Development reported through SEN. RAHMAN of the 4th Dist., Chairperson of the Committee on the part of the Senate, that the bill ought to pass.

***AN ACT REQUIRING THE OFFICE OF POLICY AND MANAGEMENT
TO ESTABLISH A PROGRAM TO ASSIST MUNICIPALITIES IN
PUBLISHING CERTAIN BUDGET INFORMATION.***

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

- 1 Section 1. (NEW) (*Effective October 1, 2026*) (a) The Secretary of the
2 Office of Policy and Management shall, within available appropriations,
3 establish a program to (1) provide any municipality with technical and
4 financial assistance concerning the electronic publication of municipal
5 budgets and other information concerning municipal finances on the
6 Internet web site of the municipality, and (2) adopt guidelines for best
7 practices concerning the publication of such budgets and information.
- 8 (b) The secretary shall establish an application procedure and any
9 criteria for a municipality's participation in the program as deemed
10 necessary by the secretary. The secretary may adopt regulations, in
11 accordance with the provisions of chapter 54 of the general statutes, to
12 implement the provisions of this section.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:

Section 1	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	New section
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PD *Joint Favorable*

The following Fiscal Impact Statement and Bill Analysis are prepared for the benefit of the members of the General Assembly, solely for purposes of information, summarization and explanation and do not represent the intent of the General Assembly or either chamber thereof for any purpose. In general, fiscal impacts are based upon a variety of informational sources, including the analyst's professional knowledge. Whenever applicable, agency data is consulted as part of the analysis, however final products do not necessarily reflect an assessment from any specific department.

OFA Fiscal Note

State Impact:

Agency Affected	Fund-Effect	FY 27 \$	FY 28 \$
Policy & Mgmt., Off.	GF - Potential Cost	See Below	See Below

Note: GF=General Fund

Municipal Impact: None

Explanation

The bill requires the Office of Policy and Management (OPM) to provide technical and financial assistance to support municipalities publishing their budgets and other financial information on their websites and adopt guidelines for such publication. This information is already available on OPM's website¹, and it is anticipated that they can provide technical assistance and establish guidelines within available resources. There is a potential cost to OPM to the extent that financial assistance is required by municipalities.

The Out Years

The annualized ongoing fiscal impact identified above would continue into the future subject to inflation.

¹ OPM's Municipal Budget Database-
<https://opm-mbds.ct.gov/ords/r/mbds/mbds/budget-files?clear=5>
 OPM's Electronic Audit Reporting System-
<https://ears.opm.ct.gov/>
 OPM's Municipal Fiscal Indicators-
<https://portal.ct.gov/OPM/IGP-MUNFINS/Municipal-Financial-Services/Municipal-Fiscal-Indicators>

OLR Bill Analysis**SB 275*****AN ACT REQUIRING THE OFFICE OF POLICY AND MANAGEMENT TO ESTABLISH A PROGRAM TO ASSIST MUNICIPALITIES IN PUBLISHING CERTAIN BUDGET INFORMATION.*****SUMMARY**

This bill requires the Office of Policy and Management (OPM) secretary to establish a program, within available appropriations, to help municipalities publish their budgets and other financial information on their websites. As part of this program, the secretary must give municipalities technical and financial assistance and adopt guidelines on best practices for publishing this information.

Under the bill, the OPM secretary must establish an application process and any participation criteria he deems necessary, and he may adopt regulations to create the program.

EFFECTIVE DATE: October 1, 2026

COMMITTEE ACTION

Planning and Development Committee

Joint Favorable

Yea 20 Nay 0 (03/06/2026)